

Aussie Primary Academy

Year 3 English – Writing: The Mysterious Door (Narrative)

I can: write an exciting story with a beginning, problem and ending using descriptive language!

Name: _____

Date: _____

Page 1 – Learn & Practise

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Writer's Toolkit: Similes & Metaphors

A **simile** compares two things using "like" or "as" (e.g. "as brave as a lion").

A **metaphor** says one thing IS another to create a strong picture (e.g. "the classroom was a zoo").

Example: "The door creaked like an old ship" (simile) "Fear was a heavy blanket over me" (metaphor)

1 Vocabulary Bank — use these in your writing

creaked

suddenly

curious

trembling

ancient

echoed

peered

shadowy

astonished

daring

2 Warm-Up: Simile or Metaphor?

Read each sentence and write S (simile) or M (metaphor):

a) The hallway was a dark tunnel. (____)

b) His heart beat like a drum. (____)

c) The silence was a thick fog. (____)

3 Write your own simile or metaphor

Finish this simile: The door creaked like _____.

Finish this metaphor: My fear was a _____.

4 Planning Organiser

Where is the door?

Who finds it?

What is the problem?

How does it end?

5 Now write your mysterious door story! (beginning, middle and end)

My Writing Checklist

- ☐ I used good vocabulary
- ☐ I used correct punctuation
- ☐ I included metaphors
- ☐ I included similes
- ☐ My writing is clear and complete

High-Five Tips for Parents & Teachers

Ask your child to tell the story aloud first before writing — this helps them hear if it flows.
Encourage a clear problem in the middle of the story — stories need tension to stay exciting.
Model 'show don't tell': instead of 'he was scared', try 'his hands were shaking'.
Celebrate creative ideas first, then help tidy up spelling and punctuation.
Read a short mystery story together beforehand for inspiration.

✓ **Sample Answer Guide**

Warm-Up: a) M b) S c) M

Checklist: check for a clear beginning-problem-ending structure, descriptive verbs and adjectives, at least one simile/metaphor, and correct sentence punctuation.